

Laundry and Care of Textile Products - Revision Notes

Laundry and Care of Textile Products

Definition: Laundry and care of textile products refers to the processes involved in cleaning, drying, ironing, storing, and maintaining fabrics and garments to keep them clean, attractive, and durable.

Objectives:

- Maintain cleanliness and hygiene.
- Preserve quality and appearance.
- Prolong lifespan of textiles.
- Remove stains, dirt, and odors.
- Ensure proper storage and maintenance.

Laundry Process:

1. Collection of laundry
2. Sorting
3. Mending and stain removal
4. Washing
5. Rinsing
6. Drying
7. Ironing/Pressing
8. Folding and Storage

Methods of Removing Different Clothing Stains

Blood – Soak in cold water, then wash with soap.
Tea/Coffee – Rinse with cold water and apply detergent.
Ink – Dab with rubbing alcohol and wash.
Grease/Oil – Apply absorbent powder, then detergent.
Mud – Allow to dry, brush off, and wash.
Fruit Juice – Rinse immediately with cold water.
Grass – Rub with detergent and wash.
Sweat – Soak in warm water with detergent.
Lipstick – Apply detergent or alcohol before washing.
Rust – Use lemon juice and salt, then wash.

Methods of Washing Different Fabrics

Cotton – Hand or machine wash.
Linen – Wash in lukewarm water.
Wool – Hand wash in cold/lukewarm water with mild detergent.
Silk – Gentle hand wash in cold water.
Synthetic Fabrics – Machine or hand wash.
Rayon – Gentle washing, avoid wringing.
Denim – Wash inside out in cold water.
Delicate Fabrics – Hand wash or delicate cycle.

Types of Washing Clothes

1. Hand Washing
2. Machine Washing
3. Dry Cleaning

Wet Washing uses water and detergent.

Dry Cleaning uses chemical solvents instead of water.

Dry Cleaning

Definition: Cleaning garments using chemical solvents instead of water.

Process:

1. Inspection and collection
2. Tagging
3. Pre-treatment of stains
4. Cleaning with solvent
5. Drying
6. Pressing and finishing
7. Final inspection
8. Packaging and storage

Advantages:

- Protects delicate fabrics
- Prevents shrinkage
- Preserves colour and texture
- Effective on grease stains

Laundry Agents

Laundry agents are substances used in washing clothes and textiles.

Types:

- Soap
- Detergents
- Bleaches
- Fabric softeners
- Starch
- Bluening agents
- Water

Soapy and Soapless Detergents

Soapy Detergents:

- Made from fats and oils
- Form scum in hard water
- Work best in soft water

Soapless Detergents:

- Synthetic detergents
- Work in hard and soft water
- Do not form scum
- Better at removing grease and stains

Water Hardness

Definition: Presence of calcium and magnesium salts in water.

Types:

1. Temporary Hardness – Removed by boiling.
2. Permanent Hardness – Cannot be removed by boiling.

Effects:

- Poor lather formation
- More soap required
- Clothes become dull and stiff

Softening Methods:

- Boiling
- Washing soda
- Water softeners
- Soapless detergents

Laundry Finishes

Definition: Treatments applied after laundering to improve appearance and durability.

Types:

- Starching
- Ironing
- Pressing
- Steaming
- Sizing
- Calendering

Importance:

- Improves appearance
- Helps garments retain shape
- Increases durability

Difference Between Ironing and Pressing

Ironing:

- Move the iron back and forth.
- Removes wrinkles from the whole garment.

Pressing:

- Lift and lower the iron without sliding.
- Shapes seams, pleats, and specific areas.
- Common in tailoring and garment finishing.

Storage of Textiles

Storage is usually the final stage of the laundry process, not a laundry finish.

Guidelines:

- Fold or hang garments properly.
- Store in a clean, dry place.
- Protect from dust, moisture, insects, and sunlight.

